



Dissertation planning checklist

Turn a large research project into manageable decisions.

Research direction

- ☐ My topic is focused enough for the available time and word count.
- ☐ I can state the problem or question clearly.
- ☐ I have discussed feasibility and scope with my supervisor.
- ☐ I understand the intended contribution of the project.

Literature and method

- ☐ I have a repeatable search strategy for relevant sources.
- ☐ I record citations and notes as I work.
- ☐ My proposed method fits the research question.
- ☐ I have identified ethics, permissions and data requirements.

Project plan

- ☐ I have milestones for reading, data work, drafting and revision.
- ☐ I have allowed time for supervisor feedback.
- ☐ I keep decisions, changes and questions in a research log.
- ☐ I have a secure backup routine for files and data.

Writing and review

- ☐ Each chapter has a clear job in the overall argument.
- ☐ I separate description, evidence and analysis.
- ☐ I verify referencing and presentation requirements early.
- ☐ I remain responsible for every part of the submitted dissertation.

Use this checklist as a planning aid and adapt it to your institution, provider or circumstances. CampusLync guidance does not replace university rules or qualified legal, financial or immigration advice.